

area in the centre of the image. Choose 'Fill...' from the 'Edit' menu. Fill the selection area with black at 100 per cent opacity.

Choose 'None' from the 'Select' menu to deselect the area. Then choose 'Gaussian Blur...' from the 'Blur' submenu in the 'Filter' menu. Use a radius setting of between 10 and 20 pixels. You have now applied the 'Gaussian Blur' to the 'Quick Mask' channel.

Select a special effects filter from the 'Filter' menu. For example, you can use the 'Sprayed Strokes'. Since you are still in the 'Quick Mask' mode and there is nothing selected, only the 'Quick Mask' channel will be affected by the filter.

Click the 'Standard Selection Mode' button in the Photoshop toolbox. This will select the area of the image that is not masked by the 'Quick Mask' channel. Fill the area with a background colour, and you're done.

Glowing Type

 Start with a new image and fill it with your background colour. Create a new layer and use the 'Type Mask' tool to enter your text. Use **Select > Modify > Expand** to expand the 'Type Mask'.

Now feather the selection: **Select > Feather**. Use '4', for example. Fill the selection with a colour of your liking for the 'glow'.

Now that you have your glow, use the 'Type' tool in the 'Layers' mode and enter your text again using any colour. Play with the 'Expand' and 'Feather' settings to create suit your preferences.

Dotted Lines

 Here's a simple way to create dotted lines. Open a new document, any size, say 200 pixels wide and of any height. First of all, choose the pencil tool to make sure the settings apply to this set of brushes. Before doing anything else, be sure to save your brushes if you have a fancy set of brushes that have been already tampered with. You will be playing with the settings and

it is always nice to be able to load your previous set.

Double-click on the second smallest brush in the palette window. Your palette should look rough as we are working with the pencil tool.

The smoother brush version will come later. You are now viewing the brush options. The important change you need to do for the dotted line effect is the spacing. Simply change the 'Spacing' option to 250 per cent. Here, you can enter any figure up to 999.

Now, simply draw with your pencil and you have your dotted line! To make sure your line is straight, hold down the shift key while you draw the line. Another technique is to single-click your starting point and then while holding the shift key, single-click your ending point; Photoshop draws the dotted line between the two points.

Switch over to the Paintbrush and see that the same effect is created, only with smoother anti-aliased dots. All of the same options also apply to the Airbrush tool as well.

Along with the size and spacing of the dots, if you need to do dotted lines with an oblong shape that are on an angled line, simply change the angle of the brush. Just like a calligraphy pen, you can change the angle of the stroke of your brush; however, in this case it changes the direction of the dot in your line.

Create A Textured Background

 Start by creating a new image, 200 x 200 @ 72 dpi. Switch to the channels palette and create a new channel. With the new channel active, apply the 'Noise' filter and adjust the levels till you get the effect you desire. Return to the RGB channel and apply the Lighting effects filter: Lighting Source: Directional Intensity: 20 Focus: 50 Gloss: 100 (shiny) Material: 75 (plastic) Exposure: 45 Ambience: 13

Texture Channel: #4

White: high

Now that you have your texture, apply offset 100 to the left and 100 down, making sure 'Wraparound' is checked. Once you have applied the Lighting filter you also need to colour your new background.

To do so, create a new layer and fill with the colour you want your background to be. Go to the layer palette and change the 'Layer' mode to 'Color Dodge'. And there you have it—your textured background!

Wrapping Text In A Circular Fashion

 Starting with a new image, place your text making sure it just touches the left edge of the image. Now go to the 'Layers' palette and uncheck 'Preserve Transparency', with this option unchecked you can now wrap the text.

But first, we must re-scale the text so that when it is wrapped it does not look squashed. Go to **Layer > Transform > Scale**, and increase the height of the text by about one half.

Now we need to make a square selection around the text. Use the marquee tool and press [Shift] while drawing a perfect square around the type. If the selection is not centred on the text, just right use the arrow keys to adjust it.

All that is left now, is to apply **Filter > Distort > Polar Coordinates** and select 'Rectangular to Polar'.

Photoshop CS Shortcuts

The Work Area

 [Tab] hides your palettes and tools.
☐ [Shift] + [Tab] only hides the palettes.
☐ [Ctrl] + [Tab] cycles through all open image windows including the File Browser.
☐ Press [Alt] and click on the image info area at the bottom of the document window (the Status bar on Windows) to access the actual pixel dimensions of the document (width, height,

Bet You Didn't Know

Make An Image Look Like It's Moving Towards You

Pick a favourite picture of yours—a car, an animal, whatever. Make sure the image is in RGB mode. You can check by clicking on Image and then Mode. Make a quick mask. Select the area of the image you want to look clear, using the lasso or marquee tool. Now select **Select > Inverse**, then **Edit > Fill**. Fill with black 100%, then do **Select > None**.

Apply a Gaussian blur around 13 or 14 (9 or 10) for small images. Now use the **Brush Strokes > Sprayed Strokes** filter. Stroke length 12, radius 7, right diagonal.

Now go back to Standard edit mode. Inverse your selection. Apply a radial blur zoom, amount 40, and there you have it!

channels and resolution).

☐ [Ctrl] + [Page Up] or [Page Down] moves left or right one full screen.

☐ [Home] moves to the upper left corner. [End] moves to the lower right corner.

Rulers And Guides

 [Ctrl] + [R] shows or hides the rulers.
☐ [Ctrl] + [;] shows the guides.
☐ [Ctrl] + ['] shows grids.
☐ Use the right mouse button in the ruler area to access units from the context-sensitive menu.
☐ When dragging out a guide from the rulers, [Alt] changes the orientation of the guide (vertical to horizontal and vice versa).
☐ Reposition a guide using the 'Move' tool (position the 'Move' tool directly on top of the guide). When the icon changes to a double-headed arrow, click and drag to reposition the guide.
☐ Drag a ruler outside the image area, if you want to quickly delete it.
☐ Set the rulers to percentage to quickly find the centre of an image.
☐ Reset the origin of the rulers by clicking and dragging from the intersection of the rulers.